



ZENITH INSIGHT SERIES

Cost Containment and Stop-Loss Pricing

How operational decisions influence claim severity, volatility, underwriting confidence, and renewal strategy.

ZENITH RISK STRATEGIES

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Claims history is important, but it does not explain the entire risk profile

Access, navigation, vendor performance, and intervention can change how risk develops during the plan year.

The backward-looking model

Traditional underwriting begins with prior claims, demographics, and trend. Those inputs matter, but they can miss the employer's ability to influence future utilization and severity.

Questions history alone cannot answer

- Which care pathways are actively managed?
 - How quickly are high-risk cases identified?
 - Are vendors accountable for measurable actions?
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The operating view

A more complete assessment connects experience data with the plan's clinical and operational capabilities. The objective is not to assume savings; it is to understand whether the employer can execute a credible strategy.

Better underwriting confidence begins with better evidence of operating discipline.

Cost containment works through coordinated decisions, not isolated programs

The most relevant levers depend on the population, plan design, provider access, and existing vendor environment.

Clinical and access levers

- Care navigation
- Centers of excellence
- Direct primary care
- High-cost claimant intervention

Financial and vendor levers

- Pharmacy contract review
- Network and reference-pricing strategy
- Transparent fee analysis
- Performance reporting and governance

A program should be evaluated on evidence, member experience, and repeatable execution - not a headline savings estimate.

Translate operational performance into an underwriting narrative

A renewal submission is stronger when it explains what happened, what changed, and how future risk will be managed.

01

Measure

Document claims, interventions, recoveries, and vendor actions.

02

Explain

Connect the results to specific clinical or operational decisions.

03

Validate

Separate repeatable improvements from one-time variance.

01

Model

Test how the updated risk profile affects retention and protection options.

02

Present

Give underwriters a clear, evidence-based account of the plan's operating discipline.

Zenith integrates underwriting and strategy so renewal decisions are grounded in both risk and execution.